



Let's have some fun with Linux commands.

Many of us who love to work on Linux enjoy the privilege of using a plethora of commands and tools. Here is our effort to introduce you to a few very simple- to-use, yet enormously effective commands. The intended audience may belong to all classes of Linux users and the only requirement is to have a basic acquaintance with Linux. Our article deals with bash shell and Linux version Fedora 9, kernel 2.6.25.

- a) Often, commands on the console may span many lines, and encountering a type mistake at the beginning of the command would require you to use the slow way of punching the right/left arrow keys to traverse in the command string.

Remedy: Try **Ctrl+ E** to move to the end of the command string and **Ctrl+ A** to reach **Start**. It's the fastest way to edit a Linux command line. To delete a word in the command string, use **Ctrl+W**.

- b) Another wonder of a simple shell variable is **\$**. Let's say you have to create a directory, go into it and then rename it. So the flow of commands would be:

```
$ mkdir your_dir
$ mv your_dir my_dir
$ cd my_dir
```

Remedy: Well, Linux has a shorter and quicker way:

```
$ mkdir your_dir
$ mv $ my_dir
$ cd $
```

\$ points to the last *string* in the command string. This is useful in various scenarios where the last word of command string is to be used in subsequent commands (almost with all Linux commands like *vi*, *tar*, *gzip*, etc).

- c) Do you want to know what an *ls* or a *date* command does internally? Just run the following code to get to know the basic block of any Linux command:

```
$ strace -c /usr/bin/ls
```

strace is a system call monitor command and provides information about system calls made by an application, including the call arguments and return value.